

Claude's Entry

90-Day AI Business Competition

Business plan, version 1 · Prepared on Day 1 (2026-09-15) by Claude, the autonomous operator

Bankroll: up to CA\$1,000 · Period: 2026-09-15 to 2026-12-13 · Owner: Jake (StateFarm91) · Repository: github.com/StateFarm91/Project-Money

This plan is the operator's own decision, made on the evidence gathered on Day 1 and recorded in the project repository. Every number in it is labelled as either a measured fact with a source, or an estimate. Projections are separated from actuals throughout. The plan changes only through the decision log; the repository is the live version and always wins over this document.

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1. Executive summary

The mission is to build and operate the strongest legitimate business outcome from a maximum of CA\$1,000 over 90 days, with minimal owner involvement, against two competing AI entries. The scoreboard is real revenue from real strangers and net profit after fees, advertising and refunds. Nothing else counts.

On Day 1 the operator researched 42 materially different opportunities across 12 market lenses with live web evidence, ranked them on the directive's criteria, deep-dived five finalists, and had an independent adversarial reviewer attack the leading plan. The decisive finding was about distribution: with no audience, no outreach (Canada's anti-spam law forbids cold contact) and no human posting daily, the only channels where buyers are already present and can be reached cheaply within 90 days are marketplaces with native search and paid social advertising. Everything else (software tools, directories, content, lead generation) needs months of search-engine or community presence that cannot be bought in this window.

The plan therefore runs two tracks that share one owner setup:

- Track A, MapleSheets on Etsy (the floor). A shop of Canadian small-business templates: a T2125-mapped bookkeeping system, a GST/HST quick-method calculator, home-office and vehicle workbooks, a tax planner, and a print-on-demand line of Canadian gifts. Two products are already built and validated. Etsy supplies the buyers; in-marketplace ads cost cents per click. Base case is modest (CA\$300-450 revenue by Day 90) with near-zero downside and a catalogue that peaks in tax season after the competition.
- Track B, Pine and Nook (the swing). A Shopify store selling three research-selected physical products to Canada and the US through Meta ads during Q4, fulfilled by suppliers with 3-8 day US-warehouse shipping, with AI-generated creatives and an AI customer-support agent. It is run as a staged experiment: three products at CA\$50 of ads each, kill fast; one survivor gets up to CA\$250 more, scaled only while measured return holds. Roughly three in four first-time stores lose their test budget; if this one hits, CA\$3,000-8,000 of revenue by Day 90 is realistic. The cap is about half the bankroll, so a miss leaves the floor intact and CA\$290 in reserve.

Money: Track A up to CA\$190, Track B up to CA\$520, reserve at least CA\$290. Spent to date: CA\$0.00. The caps are enforced in code before any budget can be created or raised, and every ad campaign carries a lifetime budget inside Meta so nothing can run away between operator runs.

Owner involvement: one Etsy setup of about 45 minutes, and one store-stack setup of about two hours in three parts. After that the owner reads a weekly summary and answers only identity checks a platform may spring. Operations run unattended through a scheduled operator session three times a day.

What would change the plan: only data. Fewer than 150 Etsy views in the first 14 days reworks the listings before ad spend. No product clearing stage 1 ends Track B. A product clearing it is scaled on measured return and nothing else.

2. Mandate, rules and constraints

2.1 The competition

Item	Value
Start (recorded)	2026-09-15 11:00:07 UTC (Day 1)

Item	Value
Official end (Day 90)	2026-12-13
Unofficial durability review (Day 180)	2027-03-13
Maximum starting bankroll	CA\$1,000
Stretch target	CA\$25,000+ legitimate economic outcome (a stretch, not a licence for irrational risk)
Competitors	Claude vs ChatGPT vs Grok, each choosing its own strategy
Scoreboard	Gross revenue; net profit after platform, payment, advertising, refunds and operating costs; cash and capital deployed; recurring revenue; legitimate customers and unit economics; owner hours; conservative Day-180 asset value

2.2 What the operator can and cannot do

The operator is Claude Code running in a cloud sandbox with web research, code, GitHub, and the ability to schedule itself. It can build and deploy software, generate images and (through paid APIs) video, call any API the owner authorizes, and run unattended on a schedule. It cannot create accounts that need identity verification, pass CAPTCHAs, spend money itself, make phone calls, handle physical goods, or post on social platforms from a personal account. It is not online in real time between scheduled runs, so anything customer-facing that must respond in minutes is built as a deployed service.

2.3 Owner constraints

- The owner runs another business and has a family. Involvement is limited to identity verification, account creation, accepting terms, providing credentials, and authorizing spend. The owner confirmed on Day 1: no restrictions on setup, no operating role.
- Jurisdiction is Canada (CAD). CASL forbids unsolicited commercial email or messages, so cold outreach is excluded as a channel. Under CA\$30,000 of taxable supplies the business is a GST/HST small supplier; the ledger tracks the threshold.
- The operator's compute is rate-limited on the owner's Claude plan (five-hour usage windows). Day 1 lost five hours to this and the operating cadence was redesigned around it.

2.4 Non-negotiables

- Real customers and real revenue only. No circular transactions, fake reviews, fabricated scarcity, invented usage numbers or projections presented as earnings.
- An auditable ledger of actual events with evidence references; projections kept in a separate file.
- No platform-rule bypass, no secrets in the repository, no legal or financial commitments without the account holder.
- Everything customer-facing must be genuinely useful and honest, including delivery times and product claims.

3. Market research: what was investigated and what it showed

3.1 Method

Twelve lens-specific researchers swept the opportunity space with live web search on 2026-09-15: vertical micro-SaaS; digital products on marketplaces; the AI-agent and developer-tool ecosystem; app-store distributed products; AI-fulfilled productized services; content, affiliate and data products; e-commerce and print-on-demand; Canada-specific and regulatory opportunities; first-hand revenue reports of what made money fast in 2025-26; arbitrage from 2026 shutdowns and rule changes; consumer micro-utilities with search intent; and niche marketplaces, directories and lead generation. They produced 42 materially different candidates, each with evidence URLs labelled as evidence or assumption, capital and time-to-revenue estimates, a first-10 and first-100 customer plan, and the single biggest failure reason. Sixteen verification searches then checked the facts that decided the ranking, five finalists were deep-dived, and an adversarial reviewer attacked the leading plan with its own searches.

3.2 Findings by lens (the parts that mattered)

- Marketplaces split into two kinds. Etsy, Teachers Pay Teachers, Eloquent and the Notion Marketplace have built-in buyer search; Gumroad and Lemon Squeezy do not. Gumroad's own 2026 data: median creator earns US\$72/month, 44% of products earn nothing, and its discovery feed is closed to products without prior sales. Etsy's digital downloads are not held in payment reserves and its seller API is approved in minutes for an owner's own shop.
- Platform review queues decide 90-day feasibility. Chrome Web Store 1-3 days; Stripe App Marketplace about 4 business days; WordPress.org 1-10 days; Shopify App Store 2-6 weeks; Atlassian 10-15 business days plus a required business entity and a mandatory 30-day trial; Google Workspace add-ons need OAuth verification that can take weeks.
- The AI-agent tool ecosystem is supply-heavy and thin on paying demand. Anthropic's plugin marketplaces have no payment layer, the biggest 'products' are free repositories with tens of thousands of stars, and fewer than 5% of MCP servers are monetized. Anything that is 'just configuration' competes with free.
- Regulatory deadlines are the strongest 2026 demand drivers found. The European Accessibility Act has been enforceable since June 2025; Ontario organizations with 20+ employees must file an AODA compliance report by 2026-12-31 (the website WCAG obligation applies to 50+ employees); Quebec's Bill 96 is complaint-driven with first-offence fines around CA\$3,000 for English-only web content; Stripe Invoicing now has native late fees, which killed one candidate.
- E-commerce realities. TikTok Shop is not available in Canada. Redbubble takes 50% from standard-tier artists since September 2025. KDP publishers earn US\$0-30/month in their first six months. Print-on-demand through Printify with Canadian providers yields 30-50% margins and 4-8 day domestic shipping. For paid-social dropshipping, a rigorous single-product test costs about CA\$667 of ads, first-timers who sustain spend succeed about 18% of the time within 90 days, and profitable stores net 15-35%.
- What made money fast in 2025-26 (first-hand reports). Launch and listing platforms monetized by featured slots (one reached US\$2,000 MRR in 19 days, with an existing audience), pay-once utilities with near-zero costs, and developer APIs sold by building in public. The median path to US\$1,000 MRR is still 12-18 months.
- Canada-specific. Canadian fintech affiliate programs pay unusually well (up to CA\$1,250 per funded client) but approvals and search ranking put first revenue past Day 45; Quebec's Bill 96 created demand for bilingual documents and French-content checks; Canadian bookkeeping templates already sell on Etsy with 4.8-star listings and few Canadian-specific competitors.

3.3 Ranking criteria

Each candidate was scored 0-5 on eight criteria with weights reflecting the directive: demand evidence (3), distribution reachable without outreach and speed to the first ten customers (3), time to first revenue (2), Day-90 net-profit potential (3), executability by the operator with minimal owner time (3), platform, terms-of-service, approval and legal risk (2), competition and differentiation (2), and Day-180 asset value (1). Candidates whose first-customer plan depended on posting in communities were marked down, because the operator cannot do that and the owner should not have to. The full table is in Appendix A.

3.4 Finalists and what the adversarial review changed

Finalist	Verdict	Why
Etsy shop of Canadian small-business templates	Selected (Track A)	Verified buyer search on Etsy, seller API approved in minutes, cheap in-marketplace ads; downgraded to a modest, roughly break-even base case because Sept-Dec is off-season for tax templates and a zero-review shop converts below average
AODA/WCAG accessibility scanner (free scan, paid report, monitoring)	Rejected as a track; backlog only	The Dec-31 filing for 20-49 employee organizations is a self-attestation with no website check; automated reports are a commodity with free scanners from major vendors; a CA\$100 search-ads test cannot signal at CA\$3-5+ per click; a new domain will not rank inside 90 days
Bill 96 French-content scan and translation pack	Parked	Shopify's free Translate & Adapt and CA\$17/month apps make French cheap; no evidence of paid intent; services are excluded from merchant-of-record payment providers
Chat export to court-ready PDF	Screened out	Proven paid intent but five active entrants in 18 months saturate the search results a new domain would need
Express Entry draw alerts	Screened out	Huge audience and fully automatable, but every first-customer path runs through community posting the operator cannot do
Paid-social dropshipping store	Added as Track B after the owner removed setup restrictions	Excluded at first for owner time, no video capability and no support capacity; re-evaluated once an AI support agent, AI video and unrestricted accounts were on the table; kept only with hard stage gates because of its base rate

3.5 What was excluded and why

- Amazon: its policy forbids the third-party-fulfilled dropshipping model; FBA needs inventory capital (a single product order would consume the bankroll) and 3-5 weeks of lead time before any sale.
- TikTok Shop: not launched in Canada; workarounds risk account termination. TikTok ads are deferred until Meta results exist.
- Organic social (TikTok, Instagram, Reddit): requires a human posting from personal accounts daily; the owner has no operating role and the operator cannot post.
- Cold outreach of any kind: CASL.
- Software tools, directories, job boards, content sites: first revenue past Day 45 or dependent on search ranking that takes months; several kept warm in the backlog for Day 180.

4. Strategy: two tracks, one setup, hard caps

The strategy is a portfolio chosen for probability-weighted outcome with the bankroll protected: a high-probability, low-cost floor that compounds, and a capped swing with the only ceiling worth

having inside 90 days. Both use the only two channels with present buyers and cheap access. Both are run by the operator end to end after a single owner setup.

	Track A: MapleSheets (Etsy)	Track B: Pine and Nook (Shopify + Meta ads)
Role	Floor and compounding asset	Swing with stage gates
Customers	Canadian sole proprietors, freelancers, Etsy/Shopify sellers doing their own T2125 bookkeeping; gift buyers for the print-on-demand line	Consumers in Canada and the US buying impulse-priced physical products in Q4
Distribution	Etsy search, Etsy Ads (US\$0.20-0.60 per click), reviews compounding	Meta Advantage+ shopping campaigns with lifetime-capped budgets; AI-generated video and image creatives
Fulfilment	Etsy delivers files; Printify prints and ships gifts	CJ Dropshipping US warehouses (3-8 days) or Canadian suppliers; tracking synced to the store
Support	Etsy messages, replies drafted by the operator	AI support agent (email) with order lookup; escalation to the operator within 8 hours
Capital cap	CA\$190 (setup CA\$40, ads up to CA\$150)	CA\$520 (tools CA\$90-120, stage 1 ads CA\$150, stage 2 ads CA\$250, one sample)
P(first revenue within 30 days of launch)	About 40%	About 55% (sales come fast when ads work; profit is the hard part)
Day-90 base case	CA\$300-450 revenue, about break-even to +150 net	CA\$400-900 revenue, about -150 to +150 net
Day-90 upside	CA\$1,200-1,800 revenue	CA\$3,000-8,000 revenue, +600 to +2,000 net
Downside	About -CA\$250	About -CA\$450
Kill rule	<150 views in 14 days: rework before ads; 100 ad clicks with no sale: stop ads	Per product: CA\$50 spent with no purchase, or 60 clicks with no add-to-cart; track: no product passes stage 1

Why not one track. The floor alone cannot produce a competitive outcome; the swing alone risks the bankroll on a bad base rate. Together, the worst case preserves the reserve and a compounding catalogue, and the best case is a real number. Why not other swings: nothing else in the 42 candidates combines present buyers, cheap access and a 90-day window.

5. Track A: MapleSheets on Etsy

5.1 Products

#	Product	Price (CAD)	Status
1	Canadian Sole Proprietor Bookkeeping System, T2125 edition 2026 (Excel + Google Sheets): income and expense ledgers mapped to every T2125 Part 4 line, sales tax by province (GST/HST/PST/RST/QST), home-office Part 7 with the loss cap and carry-forward, vehicle Chart A, regular-vs-quick-method GST/HST comparison with RC4058 rates and the 1% credit, \$30,000 small-supplier tracker, dashboard; quick-start PDF and README	29	Built; validated (0 formula errors across 6,122 cells; key values verified); packaged with six listing images
2	GST/HST Quick Method vs Regular Method Calculator + Small-Supplier Tracker (standalone), including a voluntary-registration worksheet	14	Built; validated; packaged with three images
3	Home-office and vehicle expense workbook (Part 7 + Chart A) with printable logbook	12	Specified
4	Self-employed tax set-aside and instalment planner (2026 brackets verified before build)	12	Specified

#	Product	Price (CAD)	Status
5	Bundle of 1-4	44	After 1-2 are live
6	Print-on-demand line: personalized Canadian gifts (mugs, prints, totes) via Printify with Canadian print providers; automated personalization from the order field	24-34	Backlog; needs the owner's Printify connection
7	Line extensions chosen from Etsy API data: Shopify/Etsy-seller variant, therapist and allied-health practice templates	29-49	After the 14-day test

Every rate and line number was checked against CRA pages on 2026-09-15 (RC4058 quick-method tables, T2125 Part 4 and Part 7, the small-supplier rule, provincial rates including Nova Scotia's 14% HST). Workbooks use only functions that behave identically in Excel and Google Sheets, carry a version stamp and a plain-language disclaimer, and are validated by an automated formula evaluator before release. AI assistance is disclosed per Etsy's Creativity Standards; the formulas and testing are the selling point.

5.2 Economics

- Etsy fees for a Canadian seller: listing US\$0.20, 6.5% transaction, 3% + CA\$0.25 processing, GST/HST on Etsy's fees, one-time shop setup fee of US\$15-29. Net on a CA\$29 sale is about CA\$25.70 before ads (about 89%).
- Etsy Ads: minimum US\$1/day; new shops wait 15 days before ads; digital products convert at roughly 2-5% of clicks. Plan: CA\$3/day on the single best listing from about Day 21; kill at 100 clicks with no sale; raise in CA\$2/day steps only at ROAS above 2. Total ads capped at CA\$150-200.
- Base case: 11-16 sales by Day 90 at about CA\$28 average, revenue CA\$300-450, net about break-even to +150 after fees, ads and setup. Upside: a listing that ranks plus Q4 'get ready for the 2026 tax year' demand, CA\$1,200-1,800. Downside: about -250. Tax season (Feb-Apr 2027) is the peak for this catalogue and falls after Day 90; it is the Day-180 payoff.

5.3 Distribution and the 14-day test

First ten customers come from Etsy search: titles, 13 tags and attributes built from competitor keyword neighbourhoods pulled through the Etsy API, six images per listing, honest descriptions. The most important test in the plan (EXP-001) asks whether Etsy search shows a zero-review Canadian listing to real buyers: by the 14th day the shop is live, at least 150 views and either a sale or five favourites. Pass: fund ads and the bundle. Fail: rewrite titles and tags from competitor data and swap products before any ad spend. First hundred customers: reviews compounding rank, the bundle, weekly title and tag rewrites from API view data, more products in the same shop (they inherit the shop's reviews), and the print-on-demand line for Q4 gifting.

5.4 Operations

Workbooks are generated and tested by code; listings are created and updated through the Etsy API with a seller app the owner registers once; images are rendered programmatically; Etsy delivers files and receipts; a daily API pull writes views, favourites and orders to the dashboard; ledger rows come from Etsy Payments statements. The operator drafts replies to buyer messages for the owner to paste (Etsy has no messaging API); such messages are rare for digital products.

6. Track B: Pine and Nook, a paid-social store

6.1 Model

A single-brand Shopify store (brand name Pine and Nook, backup Wren Porch, both checked for conflicting businesses; a trademark search precedes the domain purchase) selling three tested physical products to consumers in Canada and the US, acquired through Meta ads, fulfilled without inventory by suppliers stocked in US warehouses or in Canada, supported by an AI agent. Q4 2026 (gifting, winter, Black Friday, holidays) falls inside the window and is the strongest season for this model.

6.2 Product selection

Products are chosen from evidence rather than instinct: paid ads that have run 30+ days in consumer niches (someone is profiting), supplier availability with 3-8 day delivery, marketplace demand signals, and a legitimacy filter (no licensed characters or look-alikes, no health or beauty claims, no fragile or battery-certified electronics, no sizing-dependent apparel, honest delivery times). Retail CA\$25-60, landed cost at most one third of retail, contribution margin after cost of goods at least 60% so ads can run at 40% of revenue or less. The Day-1 research shortlisted eight and recommended three across unrelated demand drivers:

Product	Category	Retail (CAD)	Evidence	Risk
Cocktail smoker kit (wood-only, torch-free SKU from a US warehouse)	Bar and gifting	49	Strongest: an Amazon US market report shows top-10 listings averaging about 1,480 units/month at US\$33, the leader about 7,000/month; four independent 2026 buying guides; a CJ winning-products feature	Competition from Amazon Prime; must avoid glass and torch SKUs
Magnetic windshield snow and ice cover	Auto and winter (Canada-specific)	39	Presence-based: a decade-old Amazon listing still active, '2026 New' listings, big-box retailers, and at least two single-product Shopify brands (the footprint of paid-social sellers); no sales counts found	Seasonal timing; test reads better after first frost; geo-target Canada and the northern US
Self-cleaning pet slicker brush + undercoat rake bundle	Pets	39	Two independent 2026 supplier guides agree on cost (US\$3-9) and retail (US\$22-30); multiple supplier listings verified	Saturation and low average order value, hence the bundle
Alternate: oversized hooded wearable blanket	Home comfort	45-55	Strong Q4 demand	Likely fails the landed-cost rule on shipping weight unless a US-warehouse SKU lands at or below US\$14

Supplier pages block automated fetches, so landed costs and warehouse stock are assumptions until the CJ API key exists; the three picks are re-confirmed or swapped at that point, and one sample of any product that scales is ordered (at most CA\$30) to verify quality.

6.3 Store, creatives, ads

- Store: Shopify on the CA\$1/month promotional plan (Basic is CA\$68/month after three months), built through the Admin API: products, honest shipping profiles (supplier estimate plus two days), refund and privacy policies, markets for Canada (CAD) and the US (USD), pixel installed, a support address on the store's own domain.

- Creatives: image ads composed programmatically (1080x1080 and 1080x1350; product, benefit headline, price, trust line; four variants per product) and 5-10 second videos generated from supplier photos through fal.ai (Kling or Wan models at roughly US\$0.03-0.08 per second) then cut, captioned and exported in 9:16 and 1:1 with ffmpeg; two to three variants per product at a target cost under US\$2 per product. Honest claims only; delivery time stated on the landing page.
- Ads: Meta Advantage+ shopping campaigns through the Marketing API on the owner's own ad account (no app review needed; a non-expiring system-user token), one ad set per product with a lifetime budget and end date, purchase optimization on the pixel, insights pulled daily into the dashboard. TikTok ads are deferred until Meta results exist.
- Support agent: inbound email on the store domain routed to a Cloudflare Worker that stores the message, looks up the order in Shopify and tracking at the supplier, and answers with the Anthropic API (Haiku 4.5, about half a cent per reply) for tracking, delivery-time, address-change, cancellation and in-policy refund requests, issuing refunds through Shopify where policy allows. Anything else is escalated to the next operator run (within 8 hours). Chargebacks are handled through Shopify Payments disputes with tracking evidence.

6.4 Stage gates

Stage	Budget	Rule	Pass	Fail
1 (about Days 10-24)	Three products at CA\$15/day, lifetime cap CA\$50 each (CA\$150)	Kill a product at CA\$50 spent with zero purchases, or at 60 clicks with zero add-to-carts	Any product with at least two purchases and ROAS at or above 1.2	All three killed: Track B stops, remaining budget returns to reserve, store stays up passively
2	Up to CA\$250 more on the passing product	Raise budget 30% every three days while ROAS stays at or above 1.6; retire the others	ROAS at or above 1.6 sustained on 20+ purchases; refund rate under 8%; delivery complaints under 5%	ROAS under 1.2 over any CA\$80 of spend stops scaling; under 1.0 kills
Scale	Reinvested proceeds only	Add creatives, a second country or product; raise operator cadence	Measured return holds	Any gate fails

6.5 Economics

CAD	Downside (~75%)	Base	Upside (~15%)
Revenue by Day 90	0-150	400-900	3,000-8,000
Ads	150	300-400	400 plus reinvested proceeds
Tools (Shopify promo, domain, fal.ai, Anthropic credits)	90	90	90-150
Cost of goods (about 35% of revenue)	0-50	140-315	1,050-2,800
Net	-450	-150 to +150	+600 to +2,000

These are honest odds, not a pitch. The base rate for first-time paid-ads stores is poor; research-driven product selection, honest listings, fast iteration and Q4 seasonality improve it but do not remove it. The cap and the gates exist so that the likely miss costs a bounded amount while the floor keeps running.

7. Financial plan

7.1 Capital allocation (CAD)

Bucket	Cap	Release condition
Track A: Etsy setup, listing fees, Printify (free)	40	Owner Block 1
Track A: Etsy Ads	150 (hard guard 200)	Only after the 14-day visibility test passes
Track B: tools (Shopify promo, domain, fal.ai credits, Anthropic credits)	90-120	Owner Block 2
Track B: stage 1 ads	150	Launch checklist complete
Track B: stage 2 ads	250	A product passes stage 1
Track B: one product sample	30	A product is scaling
Reserve	at least 290	Never below this floor; growth capital only on measured return
Total	1,000	

Caps are enforced by a module every budget change must pass; it reads actual spend from the ledger first and refuses any increase that would exceed a track's cap or breach the reserve floor. Meta campaigns are created only with lifetime budgets and end dates. Etsy Ads budgets are set by the owner once per instruction.

7.2 Combined projection (CAD, Day 90)

Scenario	Track A net	Track B net	Combined	Notes
Downside (both fail)	-250	-450	about -700	Reserve and the Etsy catalogue preserved; Track B store stays up at CA\$1/month
Base	0 to +150	-150 to +150	-100 to +300	Etsy sells 11-16 units; one store product converts marginally or none does
Upside	+900 to +1,300	+600 to +2,000	+1,500 to +3,300	A ranking Etsy listing plus a store product scaling on measured return; revenue CA\$4,000-10,000

The stretch target of CA\$25,000 is not the base case. It becomes reachable only in the upside path with reinvested proceeds and a second scaling product; the plan does not assume it and does not take irrational risk to chase it.

7.3 Unit economics

- Etsy template at CA\$29: net about CA\$25.70 before ads; ad-driven customer acquisition cost of CA\$5-15 in the base case; payback immediate.
- Store product at CA\$40 with CA\$13 landed cost and 2.9% + CA\$0.30 processing: about CA\$25 to cover ads and profit; break-even ROAS about 1.6; target ROAS 2.0 or better before scaling.
- Support agent: about CA\$0.007 per reply; Meta creatives: under CA\$3 per product for videos; Shopify: CA\$3 for the whole window on the promotional plan.

7.4 Ledger discipline and tax

The ledger records actual events only, one row per event with an evidence reference (receipt, payout report, statement) and running available cash. Projections live in a separate file and never mix with actuals. Revenue is recorded when the platform confirms the sale; fees and payouts when they post. Under CA\$30,000 of worldwide taxable supplies the business is a GST/HST small supplier and need

not register; the workbook line and the ledger track the threshold, and the operator alerts the owner at CA\$25,000. Records are kept for six years as the CRA requires. Etsy and Shopify Payments handle card processing; merchant-of-record services were researched (Stripe Managed Payments recommended if an own-domain digital checkout is ever needed) but are not required for this plan.

8. Milestones and targets

Day	Date	Track A (Etsy)	Track B (store)	Owner
1	2026-09-15	Two products built and validated; API client tested; heartbeat live	Research done: 3 products, brand, spec, caps	Read the plan; do Block 1 and Block 2 when convenient
7	2026-09-21	Shop live, OAuth done, competitor data pulled, listing 1 published	Store clients built; products verified against supplier data; creatives in production	Blocks done
14	2026-09-28	Listings 1-2 and bundle live; at least 50 views; 14-day test running	Store live with policies, pixel, support agent tested; launch checklist passed; stage 1 ads live	Nothing
30	2026-10-14	14-day test evaluated; ads on; first sale; four listings; print-on-demand designs live	Stage 1 decided (kill or pass); stage 2 started if a product passed	Turn on Etsy Ads (5 min)
60	2026-11-13	At least 8 sales (base); ads ROAS measured; line-extension decision	Stage 2 decided; scaling on measured return or track closed; Black Friday creatives ready	Nothing
90	2026-12-13	At least 12 sales, 3 reviews, CA\$300-450 revenue (base); Day-180 tax-season plan	Final numbers; store kept or wound down on evidence	Final report

9. Operations and automation

9.1 The operating loop

Observe, analyze, prioritize, execute, test, measure, document, iterate. Every session starts by reading the current state, priorities, owner actions and experiments from the repository, and ends by updating them, so any future context resumes without chat memory. Phases are organizational only; nothing waits for the owner to say 'continue'.

9.2 Unattended operation

- A scheduled Routine wakes a persistent operator session at 00:14, 08:14 and 16:14 UTC. Each run pulls the working branch, takes a lease lock so two sessions never edit at once, does the highest-value unblocked work (stats pulls, listing updates, creatives, ad-set gate rules, support escalations, ledger rows), persists state and pushes. The mechanism was verified on Day 1 by a real commit from the operator session.
- Hard caps live in Meta (lifetime budgets, end dates) and Etsy (daily budget set once), so spending cannot run away between runs. A kill switch pauses every ad set if return data is missing or the ledger is inconsistent.
- External writes record an idempotency key before execution, so reruns never duplicate a listing, an order or a campaign.
- The owner can pause or delete the Routine at any time from the Routines page; a failed run shows there and the next run continues from the repository.

- Compute is rate-limited (five-hour windows). Day 1's heavy research fan-out hit the limit and cost five idle hours; the plan now budgets research and build work per window and persists partial results early.

9.3 Monitoring and reporting

The dashboard carries the directive's fields: day number, starting capital, available cash, capital deployed, gross revenue, expenses, realized net profit, customers and orders, recurring revenue, acquisition cost, conversion, average order value, best product, best channel, active experiments, biggest bottleneck, Day-90 projection with assumptions, and owner time this week. Values are measured or N/A, never invented. When the owner asks 'Status?', a script prints the operator report from committed state.

10. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Likelihood	Mitigation
Etsy search never surfaces a zero-review shop	Medium	14-day test before any ad spend; competitor keyword data from the API; bundle and images; product swaps; reviews compound
Etsy account review or AI-content policy friction	Low-medium	AI assistance disclosed correctly; tested formulas as the selling point; owner answers any review request with drafted text
A wrong tax rate produces a one-star review	Low	Every rate cross-checked against CRA pages with sources; automated evaluator; version stamp; no-argument refunds
No store product converts (the base rate)	High	Capped stage 1 (CA\$150); research-driven selection; kill fast; the floor keeps running
Ad account or Business Manager restrictions from Meta	Medium	Honest creatives and landing pages; real policies; no prohibited claims; verification completed by the owner up front
Supplier delays or stock-outs	Medium	US-warehouse or Canadian suppliers only; delivery times stated honestly; tracking synced; refunds issued within policy
Refunds and chargebacks	Medium	Clear policies; support agent resolves fast; disputes answered with tracking evidence; refund rate is a stage-2 gate
Compute rate limits stall operations	Medium	Three runs per day sized to the window; caps and kill rules live inside the platforms, not in sessions
Credentials expire or break (Etsy refresh token 90 days, tokens rotated)	Medium	Expiry tracked; the operator asks the owner before expiry; no secrets in the repository
Owner unavailable for days	Expected	Everything after setup runs without the owner; owner-only needs are batched and logged

11. Compliance and ethics

- No fake reviews, testimonials, customers or usage numbers; no fabricated scarcity; no misleading claims. Delivery times are stated from supplier data plus a buffer.
- No spam. CASL: no unsolicited commercial messages; the support agent answers only inbound messages and sends no marketing.
- Platform rules respected: Etsy Creativity Standards (AI disclosure), Meta advertising policies, Shopify and supplier terms, Amazon excluded because its policy forbids the model.
- No infringing assets: product selection rejects licensed characters, brand look-alikes and trademarked designs; brand names are conflict-checked; supplier photos are used within the rights suppliers grant for listings.

- Tax and records: small-supplier threshold tracked; six-year record retention; ledger with evidence.
- Privacy: only public pages are scanned by any tool; a privacy policy on the store; customer data stays in Shopify and the support database.
- Secrets: never in the repository; environment variables and GitHub Actions secrets only.

12. What the owner does (and nothing else)

Two setup blocks, then a weekly summary. Detailed click-by-click steps are in the repository file OWNER_ACTIONS.md; this section is the summary.

Block 1: Etsy (about 45 minutes; one-time fee of about CA\$20-40)

- Create the shop at etsy.com/sell: Canada, CAD, English. Name MapleSheets (then LoonieBooks, then TrueNorthSheets).
- Create one placeholder digital listing so Etsy lets the shop open (Claude replaces it via the API).
- Complete Etsy Payments: bank details, identity (photo ID and selfie), the setup fee, seller terms.
- Register a seller API app named MapleSheets Ops at etsy.com/developers/register; put the keystring in the Claude Code environment as ETSY_KEYSTRING.
- Say 'Etsy ready' in a session; open the authorization link Claude posts; paste back the URL you land on; add the ETSY_REFRESH_TOKEN Claude returns.
- Optional (10 minutes, free): Printify account connected to the Etsy shop, API token as PRINTIFY_TOKEN.
- Later, five minutes each when asked: turn on Etsy Ads at CA\$3/day; paste drafted replies to any buyer message.

Block 2A: Shopify and supplier (about 40 minutes)

- Shopify free trial at shopify.com/ca with a placeholder store name; choose Basic on the CA\$1/month-for-three-months offer.
- Activate Shopify Payments (identity, bank).
- Create a custom app named Operator with the Admin API scopes listed in OWNER_ACTIONS.md; add SHOPIFY_ADMIN_TOKEN and SHOPIFY_STORE_DOMAIN.
- Free CJ Dropshipping account; API key as CJ_API_KEY; install the CJ app on the store.

Block 2B: domain, hosting, support agent (about 30 minutes)

- Cloudflare account with your card; accept the domain registration agreement and set a registrant contact; API token with Workers, D1, DNS, Email Routing and Registrar permissions as CLOUDFLARE_API_TOKEN, plus CLOUDFLARE_ACCOUNT_ID. Claude then buys the .com (about CA\$15) itself after a trademark check.
- Anthropic API: US\$25 of credits, a US\$40 monthly spend limit, auto-reload off, key as ANTHROPIC_API_KEY.

Block 2C: ads and video (about 45 minutes)

- Meta Business Manager with a Page for the brand, an ad account in CAD with a payment method, any verification Meta asks for.
- A Meta developer app with the Marketing API, a system user with ads_management, ads_read, business_management, pages_read_engagement and pages_manage_ads, a never-expiring token as META_SYSTEM_TOKEN; plus META_AD_ACCOUNT_ID, META_PAGE_ID and a pixel as META_PIXEL_ID.
- fal.ai account with US\$25 of credits; key as FAL_KEY.

Money: no transfers. Etsy, Shopify, Meta and the two API providers bill the cards you put on file; Claude caps and logs every charge. Total setup cost now: about CA\$20-40 (Etsy) plus CA\$1 (Shopify) plus about CA\$70 of API credits; everything else is spent only under the caps above.

13. Decision log (Day 1)

#	Decision	Why
D-001	Use StateFarm91/Project-Money as the single "operating system" repository (state, ledger, research, ops). Product code lives under products/ unless a product genuinely needs its own repository (e.g. separate deploy target or public open-source distribution), in which case it is linked from products/README.md.	A future context must be able to understand the whole business from one place. Splitting repos early adds coordination cost with no benefit.
D-002	Competition start recorded as 2026-09-15T11:00:07Z.	Execution began in this session.
D-003	Do not anchor on any prior idea; run a fresh 20+ candidate sweep with live web evidence before building anything.	Directive \$4-6; the easiest way to lose is building something nobody wants.
D-004	Scale research fan-out down to fit the rate-limited compute budget: three lean researchers for the nine remaining lenses; merge, ranking and finalist deep-dives done inline with targeted searches; one adversarial review pass instead of three skeptics per finalist.	LL-001: the first fan-out hit the five-hour usage limit and stalled the mission for ~5 hours. Depth is still adequate for a Day-1 decision because finalist assumptions become experiments with real market feedback anyway.
D-005	Initial strategy selected: Etsy shop of Canadian small-business templates (Track A), sequential; AODA/WCAG scanner deferred to a cheap pre-test; Bill 96 parked; no Google Ads; Stripe Managed Payments off the critical path.	Ranking of 42 candidates (research/OPPORTUNITY_RANKING.md), finalist deep-dives, and the adversarial review (research/ADVERSARIAL_REVIEW.md): Etsy is the only channel with native buyer search, cheap in-marketplace ads and a publishing API the operator can run alone; the scanner's demand thesis failed review; parallel tracks would starve the one that can produce revenue under the compute budget.
D-006	Etsy API credentials (refresh token) live in the Claude Code environment variables and, for scheduled jobs, GitHub Actions secrets; never in the repository. The one-time OAuth approval is an owner action.	Directive \$10/\$12: never expose secrets; owner authorizes OAuth when genuinely required.
D-007	Owner input recorded: owner doubts Etsy is the winning idea and expected dropshipping (TikTok / Amazon / social ads) to be the money maker, while leaving the call to Claude. Response: Etsy plan stands as Track A; a print-on-demand physical line (Printify, Canadian providers) is added to the backlog as the constraint-compatible form of 'buy cheap, sell higher'; a bounded paid-social dropshipping test is offered only i	Research (e-commerce lens, 2026-09-15): TikTok Shop is not available in Canada; a single product ad test costs ~CA\$667 (CPA × 50 conversions) against a CA\$1,000 total bankroll; 18% first-timer success at 90 days; dropshipping needs daily human customer service and ad creative the operator cannot produce alone.

#	Decision	Why
D-008	Owner confirmed: they will fund up to \$1,000 and open accounts on request, and take no operating role. The gated dropshipping test (D-007) is withdrawn (it needs daily human customer service and video). Track A stands; a print-on-demand physical line via Printify is added to the same Etsy shop (Q4 gifting inside the window; zero cost until an order). Owner Block 1 extended by one optional 10-minute step (Printify).	Directive §8-9: owner involvement limited to accounts, credentials and spend authorization; the operator must be able to run everything else.
D-009	Track B added: a capped, staged paid-social e-commerce store (Shopify + CJ Dropshipping + Meta ads + AI creatives + AI support agent), owner-authorized. Track A (Etsy) continues as the floor. Track B cap $\approx$ CA\$520 in two stages with product-level and track-level kill criteria; reserve $\geq$ CA\$290.	The owner reaffirmed after hearing the odds (18% first-timer success, $\sim$ CA\$667 per rigorous product test) and removed the constraints behind D-007/D-008: they will open every account, authorize spend, and accept an AI support agent and AI-generated video. With Q4 inside the window and the base track nearly free, a capped swing is the better probability-weighted play for a competition scored on outcome. Amazon (policy,
D-010	Owner clarified they defer entirely to Claude and only remove setup restrictions. Claude reaffirmed D-009 (Track A floor + capped Track B swing) as its own evidence-based decision: marketplaces and paid social are the only channels with present buyers and cheap access in a 90-day window; Amazon, TikTok Shop and organic social excluded on their merits. Parameters unchanged; all ad budgets are hard lifetime caps set in	Owner message of Day 1 evening; MASTER_STRATEGY Track B gates.
D-011	Track B provisional product set for stage 1: (1) cocktail smoker kit, wood-only/torch-free SKU, CA\$49; (2) magnetic windshield snow/ice cover, CA\$39, geo-targeted CA + northern US after first frost; (3) self-cleaning pet slicker brush + undercoat rake bundle, CA\$39. Alternate: oversized hooded blanket if a CJ US-warehouse SKU lands $\leq$ US\$14. Brand: Pine and Nook (backup Wren Porch), domain purchase only after a tradem	products/store/PRODUCT_RESEARCH.md: strongest evidence for the smoker (Amazon US top-10 averaging $\sim$ 1,480 units/month), presence-based evidence for the cover, supplier-cost evidence for the brush. All CJ landed costs are assumptions until the CJ API key exists (Block 2A); the picks are re-confirmed or swapped at that point.

Appendix A: full candidate ranking (42)

Criteria: D demand evidence (x3), R distribution reachable without outreach (x3), T time to first revenue (x2), P Day-90 net-profit potential (x3), X executability by the operator (x3), K platform and legal risk (x2), C competition and differentiation (x2), A Day-180 asset (x1). Maximum 95. Scores are the operator's judgement after verification searches; full notes are in research/OPPORTUNITY_RANKING.md.

Rank	Id	Candidate	Score	Note
1	C11	AgencyAccess (EAA/AODA accessibility monitoring + white-labe	65	FINALIST F2. AODA Dec-31-2026 filing deadline + EAA verified; automated report undercuts \$800-2,500 audits; competition confirmed (Decareto, Accessalyze, PageAudit).
2	C06	CRA-Ready Sole-Prop Bookkeeping System (Google Sheets + Exce	65	FINALIST F1. Etsy search demand verified (multiple Canadian T2125/bookkeeping listings, 4.8-star); seller-app API approved in minutes; Etsy Ads after 15-day wait.
3	C33	FrancoCheck: Bill 96 French-content audit for Quebec-facing	61	FINALIST F3. Bill 96 enforcement verified (complaint-driven, \$3k fines in 2026); fold into F2's scanner as a module rather than standalone.
4	C17	DrawWatch: Express Entry / PNP draw alerts with CRS-threshol	61	FINALIST F5 (screened). Huge audience, automatable, but discovery depends on community posting the operator cannot do.
5	C03	Agent-PR Guard GitHub Action	61	Instant GitHub Marketplace listing; Pro license via Polar; ~Day 35 first revenue; GitHub-native risk.
6	C41	ChatExhibit: WhatsApp/iMessage export to court-ready PDF	60	FINALIST F4 (screened). Proven paid intent but five paid entrants (ChatToPDF, PrintChat, ProofSnap, WaChat2PDF, whatsanalyze) saturate a new domain.
7	C08	Private-Practice OS for Therapists and Allied-Health Solo Pr	59	Runner-up: Etsy line extension if F1 works; Notion build friction for the operator.
8	C28	PulseNPS: flat-rate Stripe-native NPS/CSAT for small SaaS (D	58	Runner-up: 2.5 months late; Thrilled \$29/mo and a dozen vendors own the SERP.
9	C32	Manuel RH bilingue: Quebec bilingual (FR/EN) employee handbo	57	Legal-adjacent accuracy risk; low Etsy volume for the term.
10	C25	VibeLaunch: launch board for AI-built apps with paid feature	57	Runner-up: SoloPush anecdote relied on founder audience; cold start.
11	C04	Vibe-app RLS and secrets scan with fix pull requests (adjace	57	Real demand, but probing third-party apps needs ownership verification; crowded free-first scanners.
12	C34	Loi 25 Consent for WordPress (Freemius)	56	CookieYes/Complianz already cover Law 25; sub-1% conversion.
13	C27	Pay-once Chrome extension for Etsy sellers (listing tag/SEO	56	Downgraded by verification: eRank, EtsyHunt, Alura extensions are free/freemium.
14	C40	StatementCSV: bank/credit-card statement PDF to CSV with cre	55	Validated niche but SEO owned by incumbents; OCR/LLM cost.
15	C26	FounderSwitch: continuity dead-man's switch for solo SaaS op	55	Low urgency purchase.
16	C07	Open-Core AI-Agent Production Starter Kit sold via Gumroad/L	55	Gumroad supplies no organic traffic; launch-lottery dependence.
17	C35	MeetRoll: Google Meet attendance and chat exporter (Chrome,	54	Downgraded by verification: free 4.9-star competitors with 40k+ users.
18	C31	Avis de hausse: bilingual Quebec TAL rent-increase notice ge	54	Season (Jan-Mar 2027) falls after Day 90.
19	C10	Vertical Financial-Model and Business-Plan Templates (Excel/	54	Eloquens traffic unverified; credibility needs a named author.

Rank	Id	Candidate	Score	Note
20	C05	Role-specific Claude skills and Cowork plugin packs for non-	53	Skills are text files any Claude user can generate; no evidence packs sell.
21	C02	Stack-specific agent config and plugin packs with license-ga	53	Config packs compete with free 40k-star repos and with asking Claude to generate them.
22	C01	Agent-callable Apify pay-per-event actor portfolio	53	Apify store discovery is real but free-plan runs pay \$0; first payout ~Day 45+.
23	C29	AI-Label Kit: Article 50 disclosure + C2PA marking for small	52	Obligations bind AI providers more than small deployers; WP.org review.
24	C19	Hometown Personalized Gifts on Etsy (Printify, Canadian prin	52	Extreme POD competition; Q4 timing helps but margins thin.
25	C36	Canadian Sales Tax Invoicer for Google Sheets (Workspace Mar	51	OAuth verification 1-8+ weeks.
26	C20	Canadian Test-Prep Workbooks on Amazon KDP	51	KDP payouts 60 days in arrears; tiny velocity.
27	C42	SubTranslate: pay-per-file SRT/VTT subtitle translator with	50	Free alternatives good enough for casual users.
28	C37	Bill 96 French Storefront Pack (Shopify/WooCommerce catalogu	50	Downgraded by verification: Shopify Translate & Adapt (free) and Weglot (\$17/mo) make French cheap; services excluded from MoR; Fiverr needs owner relay.
29	C23	Exclusive-lead RFQ site for one trade in one province (e.g.,	49	Homeowner demand needs ads/ranking first; owner-medium.
30	C18	SmallBid: SMB-sized Canadian public tender alerts (CanadaBuy	49	Four indie clones already on the same free data.
31	C09	Accuracy-Verified, Curriculum-Coded Math Practice Bundles on	49	TPT algorithmic demotion of AI stores; tens of dollars per month.
32	C16	Canadian Money Tools (FHSA/TFSA/RRSP intent calculators + We	48	Affiliate approval + SEO ramp beyond Day 45; good Day-180 asset only.
33	C38	Podcast Episode Kit (transcript, chapters, show notes, clips	47	Race to the bottom; Fiverr owner relay.
34	C30	CountKit: Shopify POS stocktake, purchase-order and transfer	47	Shopify review timeline; POS UI scope.
35	C24	HostedInCanada: directory of SaaS/cloud tools with Canadian	47	Directory traffic takes >90 days.
36	C13	DeliverySettle (third-party delivery payout reconciliation f	47	Restaurant owners unreachable without outreach/Facebook groups.
37	C22	HiresCanadians: remote jobs board of roles explicitly open t	46	Chicken-and-egg; 12-18 months to meaningful revenue.
38	C15	Reorder Radar (focused Shopify inventory forecasting between	45	Shopify review 2-6 weeks + trial => Day 50-60; 573-app category.
39	C12	LateFee for Stripe Invoicing (Stripe App Marketplace)	43	KILLED by verification: Stripe Invoicing now has native late-fee rules (stripe.com resources, 2026).
40	C39	CleanList: CRM/CSV deduplication and standardisation (Upwork	42	No-review Upwork profile invisible; owner relay.
41	C14	Sprint Scope Guard (Forge 'Runs on Atlassian' app for Jira C	40	Needs a registered business entity; 30-day trial pushes cash past Day 60.
42	C21	Multi-marketplace passive POD (Redbubble/TeePublic) for nich	37	50% platform fee; not recommended by its own researcher.

Appendix B: lessons learned on Day 1

LL-001: The operator's compute is rate-limited; heavy agent fan-out is not affordable

****What happened.**** A 12-researcher opportunity-sweep workflow plus two infrastructure research agents consumed roughly 1M subagent tokens in about one hour and hit the owner's five-hour Claude usage limit at ~11:26 UTC (reset 15:10 UTC). Nine of twelve researchers and the merge step never ran; the session was idle for ~5 hours. ****Evidence.**** Workflow failure notices "You've hit your session limit · resets 3:10pm (UTC)"; session usage at 16:27 UTC: ~3.6M input, ~0.5M output, ~8.2M cache-read tokens. ****Reusable rule.**** Budget subagent work per five-hour window (target well under ~1M tokens per window). Prefer: (a) a few lean agents with capped searches over many exhaustive ones; (b) doing merge/ranking/synthesis inline instead of feeding large JSON into agents; (c) scheduling unattended runs no more than ~2-3 per day so a single firing cannot exhaust the window. Persist partial results early so a rate-limit failure loses nothing (the three completed researchers were recovered from the workflow journal).

LL-002: Validate spreadsheets with the `formulas` engine, not LibreOffice, in this sandbox

LibreOffice here is libreoffice-core only (no Calc): soffice --convert-to fails with "source file could not be loaded" even on a trivial .xlsx. The Python formulas package evaluates the whole workbook (6,122 cells in ~19 s) and catches errors; products/etsy-templates/test_workbook.py is the pattern. Keep formulas to functions that behave identically in Excel and Google Sheets.

LL-003: Check brand names against existing businesses before writing them into owner instructions

"MapleLedger" and "NorthLedger" both matched multiple existing Canadian bookkeeping firms; a shop with that name would invite confusion complaints. One web search per candidate name before use. "MapleSheets" and "LoonieBooks" were clean on 2026-09-15.

LL-004: Run the adversarial review before building, not after

The Day-1 skeptic reversed the second track (AODA scanner) by checking one legal fact the deep-dive had glossed (the 20-49 employee filing needs no website check) and by pricing the ads test realistically. Cost: ~90k tokens. It saved a 10-day build. Every new track gets a skeptic pass at the pre-test stage.

LL-005: Channels the operator can run alone are the ranking criterion that matters most

Community posting, social accounts and outreach all need the owner (and CASL forbids cold contact). Rank opportunities first by whether their first-10 channel is a marketplace with native search and a publishing API, the operator's own domain, or in-marketplace ads; discount "post in r/..." plans heavily.

LL-006: Routines that spawn fresh sessions have no repository attached

Test firing of the first heartbeat Routine (fresh session per firing) completed "SUCCEEDED" but pushed nothing: the fired session's config carried sources: [], so it had no repo checkout or push credential. Fix: create a persistent session with source_url + outcome_branch and point the Routine at it (persistent_session_id). Verify any automation by a test firing whose expected side effect is a commit you can see.

Appendix C: repository map

File or folder	Purpose
COMPETITION_RULES.md	Immutable rules and the start timestamp
MASTER_STRATEGY.md	This is Claude's competition strategy (both tracks, gates, capital)
CURRENT_STATE.md, CURRENT_PRIORITIES.md, BACKLOG.md	Operational state and the self-directed work queue
finance/FINANCIAL_LEDGER.csv, finance/PROJECTIONS.md	Actual events only; projections kept separate
KPI_DASHBOARD.md	Measured metrics; N/A where no data exists

File or folder	Purpose
EXPERIMENTS.md	EXP-001 Etsy visibility test; EXP-002 Etsy Ads; EXP-003 deferred scanner pre-test; EXP-004/005 store stage gates
DECISION_LOG.md, LESSONS_LEARNED.md	Why things changed; reusable evidence
OWNER_ACTIONS.md, CREDENTIALS_SETUP.md	The only things the owner must do; integration status (never secrets)
AUTOMATIONS.md, ops/	Heartbeat Routine, lease lock, money caps, status and ledger scripts
research/	42 candidates with evidence, ranking, finalist deep-dives, adversarial review
products/etsy-templates/	Workbook generators, validators, Etsy API client, listing copy, packages and images
products/store/	Store product research and the store stack specification
docs/	Owner directive, infrastructure research, this plan

Appendix D: key sources

All sources are listed with the claims they support in research/candidates/CANDIDATES.md, research/finalists/, research/ADVERSARIAL_REVIEW.md, products/etsy-templates/TAX_REFERENCE.md, products/store/PRODUCT_RESEARCH.md and docs/infra/. The most load-bearing ones:

- CRA: RC4058 Quick Method of Accounting for GST/HST; Form T2125 expenses section and business-use-of-home pages; GST/HST registration (small-supplier rule); business records retention.
- Etsy: seller fees for Canadian sellers, new-shop setup fee and verification, Etsy Ads minimums and the 15-day wait, Creativity Standards for AI-assisted digital downloads, Open API v3 (seller apps approved in minutes).
- Ontario AODA 2026 reporting deadline and thresholds (McCarthy Tetrault, Ogletree, Level Access); FTC order against accessiBe (no automated-compliance claims).
- Shopify Canada pricing (CA\$1/month promotion, Basic CA\$68/month); Meta Marketing API access for own ad accounts via system-user tokens; CJ Dropshipping warehouses and delivery times; Spocket and Syncee Canadian suppliers; fal.ai and Replicate video pricing; TikTok Shop Canada status.
- Dropshipping economics 2026 (testing budgets, 18% first-timer success at 90 days, 15-35% net margins); Gumroad 2026 creator data; Apify, Atlassian, Shopify App Store and Chrome Web Store review timelines and revenue-share terms.
- Amazon US market report for cocktail smoker kits (asinsight.com, July 2026) and 2026 buying guides; supplier cost guides for pet grooming tools.